Dhāraṇī for Attaining Loving-Kindness, Compassion, Joy, and Equanimity

Toh 938 · Derge Kangyur

The Dhāraṇī for Attaining the Four Immeasurables is a brief ritual text made up of four short mantras, each paired with the promise that reciting it just once will bring about one of the four immeasurable states of mind: loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity. Each mantra opens with homage to all the tathāgatas, and the work closes simply by naming itself, with no narrative frame or teaching setting. Its Sanskrit and Tibetan titles are not given in the opening lines, so it is best known by this descriptive English title. The text is Toh 938 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collection of incantations and protective formulas preserved in the Tibetan canon.

By reciting this once, one will attain loving-kindness.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatānāṃ curu curu muru muru kāruṇe kāruṇya cittamutpādaya bhagavati sarva bhayaṃ me nāśaya svāhā

By reciting this once, one will attain compassion.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatānāṃ namo bhagavati sarva satra priye hūṃ mudite svāhā

By reciting this once, one will attain joy.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatānāṃ acintya viśānī oṃ turu turu traṃ hulu hulu mulu mulu svāhā

By reciting this once, one will attain equanimity.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatā hṛdaya anugate oṃ kuruṃ gini svāhā

The Dhāraṇī for Attaining the Four Immeasurables is complete.

Translator's Notes

• Each statement "By reciting this once..." follows the dhāraṇī it refers to. The first statement, about loving-kindness, therefore belongs to a dhāraṇī that comes just before this piece. The four immeasurables (apramāṇa) are loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity. The final syllable of the colophon, written □□□, is read as the usual closing so, "is complete."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.